STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			AU-5300
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 08/13/07	DATE REVISED **02/20/25**	DATE REVIEWED 020/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE AUXILIARY UNITS: SEARCH AND RESCUE UNIT	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT SARU OPERATIONS AND TRAINING		CROSS REFERENCE G-3330 SPECIAL EVENT UNIFORM G-3320 UTILITY/JAIL UNIFORM		

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish guidelines for Search and Rescue Unit operations during deployments and training.

II. Policy:

The Search and Rescue Unit (SARU), comprised of sworn personnel, is designed to provide a twenty-four (24) hour response to lost or missing persons and to provide rescue services to individuals in hazardous situations. The SARU shall function under all policies and procedures established for the Sheriff's Office. The operations of the SARU, including training, shall be controlled by policy and procedure and shall be closely supervised by the SARU Commander.

III. Procedure:

A. Training: Deputies assigned to the SARU shall receive appropriate specialized training on an annual basis. The training program shall be developed by the SARU Team Leader and approved by the SARU Commander.

1. The SARU Team Leader shall schedule monthly training for all Unit members. All SARU members are required to attend training. If a member is unable to attend training, the SARU Team Leader must be notified prior to the training date and provided the reason the member will be unable to attend training.

2. The SARU Team Leader shall document each training exercise with a synopsis of the training and a list of all attending members. The documentation shall be forwarded to the SARU Commander and the Training Sergeant and a copy shall be maintained by the SARU Team Leader.

3. As part of SARU training, all personal and unit equipment shall be inspected and inventoried. This inspection shall occur at least annually. The SARU Team Leader or designee shall maintain a unit equipment inventory.

B. **Operations:** During deployments, the SARU Commander shall oversee and direct the Unit.

1. Any time the SARU is deployed, the Sheriff, Chief Deputy and ADC shall be notified by the SARU Commander/Supervisor.

2. When deployed for an incident, members shall respond to the storage facility to gather all appropriate Unit equipment for the type of search or rescue incident.

3. When conducting water search and rescue operations, the following procedures shall be adhered to:

a) Only a member of the SARU shall operate a Sheriff's Office boat.
b) At least one SARU member shall remain in a boat when in operation.
c) A minimum of two deputies or one deputy and another officer (i.e., Nebraska Game & Parks, DCSO, OFD) shall be in a boat when in operation. Upon approval of the SARU Commander/Team Leader, a civilian may act as the second person, while a boat is being operated.
d) Everyone in the boat shall wear a properly secured life jacket or personal flotation device (PFD).
e) A functioning portable radio shall be kept in a boat when in operation.
f) Use of a boat during inclement weather and under conditions that would endanger the users shall only be authorized by the SARU Commander or the Sheriff.
g) A boat operator may cancel operations when safety risks become too great.
h) Any employee of the Sheriff's Office shall be authorized to accompany an SARU member on a boat on a voluntary basis.
i) Any person assisting with rescue operations, where there is the potential to enter the water or to walk on ice, shall wear a properly secured PFD.

4. When conducting ice rescue operations, a life jacket or PFD shall be worn by all personnel working near or on the ice.

5. Only those SARU members trained and certified to conduct technical rescues shall perform such tasks. Non-certified SARU members may assist as directed.

6. The SARU Commander or team leader shall have the authority to request any of the following agencies be activated to respond to any incident in place of or to relieve the Search and Rescue Unit:

a) Bellevue FD water Rescue.
b) Douglas County Sheriff's Office.
c) Iowa Department of Natural Resources.
d) Nebraska Game and Parks.
e) Omaha Fire Department.
f) Omaha Police Department.
g) Papillion FD.
h) U.S. Army Corps of Engineers.
i) U.S. Coast Guard Auxiliary.
j) U.S. Coast Guard Reserves.
k) Sanders County Sheriff's Office.

7. The SARU Commander shall notify the Sheriff and ADC if another agency is utilized.

8. At the conclusion of the incident the SARU Commander/Supervisor shall notify the ADC that the incident/deployment is over. The SARU Commander/Supervisor shall provide the ADC with the details surrounding the incident.

C. **Uniforms and Equipment:** Only equipment and clothing authorized by the SARU Commander shall be used or worn.

1. The standard for SARU members shall be a gray t-shirt or hoodie with SARU logo and OD green tactical pants or shorts.

2. Each SARU member shall be issued a Rescue PFD and an Inflatable PFD. The Rescue PFD shall be worn on all call outs. The inflatable may be used during routine Patrol and Compliance checks.

3. The SARU Commander may authorize different clothing or uniform items as dictated by the circumstances of the search or rescue.